KIRAN KUMAR SHAH

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Financial Crime & Compliance Technology Leader with 17+ years driving AML/CFT program effectiveness across banking, exchange houses, and regulated financial institutions in Nepal and UAE. Unique expertise bridging regulatory compliance with technology implementation including transaction monitoring optimization, data analytics, and compliance automation.

Currently QA Manager and Trainer at A Leading Exchange House in UAE (UAE), previously MLRO at Kumari Bank (Nepal). Proven record strengthening regulatory readiness while reducing operational burden through data-driven detection, false positive reduction (up to 35%), and process optimization. Managed CBUAE and NRB regulatory examinations with zero critical findings.

KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

- **Technical Certifications:** CAMS, CAMS-Audit, CISA, CISSP, FCCA—rare combination demonstrating both regulatory and IT audit expertise
- **Technology Capability:** Python, SQL, Power BI for compliance analytics—can optimize AML platforms, not just create policies
- **Regulatory Depth:** MLRO experience managing CBUAE and NRB frameworks, FIU reporting, regulatory inspections with defensible audit trails
- **Data-Driven Compliance:** Python, SQL, Power BI, ML for detection optimization—reduced false positives 35%, built automated dashboards, piloted AI triage systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Financial Crime Quality Assurance Manager & Trainer

A Leading Exchange House in UAE | Dubai, UAE | June 2025 – Present

Drive AML/CFT operational excellence through quality assurance and technology innovation, partnering with IT and Data teams to optimize detection systems.

- Reduced transaction monitoring false positive rate from 42% to 29% through scenario recalibration and threshold optimization, saving analyst time and effort while maintaining 100% STR coverage and regulatory compliance
- Designed and implemented comprehensive QA framework covering TM, sanctions, CDD, and STR quality, achieving 94% control effectiveness score in internal audits and identifying 15+ critical control gaps
- Built Excel dashboards providing real-time MI on alert volumes, disposition timelines, false positive trends, and analyst productivity enabling data-driven decision-making for Compliance Committee and senior management
- Supported 1 CBUAE inspections with zero critical findings, preparing documentation, control testing evidence, and regulatory response materials with defensible audit trails
- Analyzed 12 months of alert data using Power Query/Excel to identify scenario performance gaps, resulting in 3 scenario retirements and 5 threshold adjustments approved by Compliance Committee, improving detection quality
- Delivered AML/CFT training enhanced with AI-generated scenario videos and interactive analytics, reducing recurring operational errors by 18% across 1000+ staff members

Principal Consultant – Financial Crime & Technology (Contract)

Governance and Innovation Pvt. Ltd | Kathmandu, Nepal | May 2024 – May 2025

- Designed and delivered AML/CFT training to 300+ professionals across banks, exchange houses, DNFBPs, and regulatory bodies covering TM, sanctions, CDD/KYC, STR filing, and financial crime typologies
- Created and conducted First Cybersecurity Bootcamp in Janakpur, training 50+ participants on cyber risk, threat awareness, security controls, and regulatory expectations
- Conducted enterprise-wide AML/CFT risk assessments for financial institutions aligned with Nepal Rastra Bank regulations and FATF standards; performed independent IT audits covering access controls, system security, data integrity, and IT governance

Head of AML/CFT (MLRO)

Kumari Bank Nepal Ltd | Kathmandu, Nepal | April 2019 – May 2024

Directed enterprise-wide AML/CFT program as designated MLRO for commercial bank with 200+ branches, 250,000+ customers, and $2B+ assets.

- Spearheaded implementation of goAML system within 3-month timeline, positioning bank among top 5 performers nationally for STR timeliness (average 2 month vs. 3 month national benchmark) and data quality (98% acceptance rate)
- Conducted annual enterprise-wide AML/CFT risk assessment covering 12 risk categories, resulting in updated customer risk rating model applied to 80,000+ accounts with improved risk stratification and resource allocation
- Built board-level compliance dashboard using Power BI, visualizing 25+ Key Risk Indicators, control performance metrics, and emerging risk trends presented quarterly to Board Audit Committee
- Achieved zero major findings in 3 NRB regulatory examinations through proactive control testing, gap remediation, and comprehensive regulatory response preparation
- Reduced customer onboarding time from days to hours while strengthening KYC quality through digitized CDD workflow and risk-based documentation requirements improving customer experience and operational efficiency

Compliance In-Charge | Information Security Officer
Laxmi Sunrise Bank Nepal Ltd | Kathmandu, Nepal | November 2016 – April 2019

- Established risk-based AML monitoring framework covering transaction monitoring, sanctions screening, and KYC quality reducing alert volumes by 28% through improved scenario design and threshold calibration
- Built bank's first Information Security Department, introducing ISO 27001 and NIST-aligned cybersecurity controls, audit logging, incident response procedures, and access management earning Letter of Appreciation from senior management
- Designed KRI/KPI frameworks for Internal Audit function, supporting control testing, audit universe definition, and compliance readiness tracking across 90 Branches.

Internal Auditor | Janata Bank Nepal Ltd & Kumari Bank Ltd
November 2009 – November 2016 (Nepal)

- Conducted IT audits, compliance reviews, and cybersecurity risk assessments to strengthen internal controls.
- Recommended fraud risk mitigation strategies, reducing audit-identified risks by 15% across operations.

PUBLICATIONS & TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Book: "The Coin That No King Could Control" (2025)
Published on Amazon Kindle. Educational guide on blockchain, crypto compliance, VASP frameworks (VARA/FATF), wallet screening, and crypto AML typologies for financial crime professionals.

Blockchain-Based CDD/EDD Compliance Prototype (2024)
GitHub: github.com/KirankShah/aml-kyc-cdd-blockchain-prototype | Ethereum/Solidity/React proof-of-concept with immutable CDD records, automated EDD triggers, and tamper-proof audit trails.

AI-Assisted AML Alert Triage System (2024–2025)
Python/scikit-learn ML model predicting alert risk scores with 85% accuracy, reducing analyst review time ~40%. Stack: Python, pandas, scikit-learn, Power BI.

Published Author – ACAMS Today (2026)
What OFAC's Crypto Mixer Sanctions Mean for Financial Crime Compliance

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Master of Science (MSc) in E-Governance (In Progress) |** Nepal Open University, Nepal | 2024
- **Master of Arts(MA) in Economics |** Nepal Open University, Nepal | 2013
- **Bachelor of Business Administration |** Tribhuvan University, Nepal | 2008

Professional Certifications:

- **Fellow Chartered Certified Accountant (FCCA)** | ACCA (UK) | 2010
- **Certified Anti-Money Laundering Specialist (CAMS)** | ACAMS | 2018
- **Certified Anti-Money Laundering Specialist – Audit (CAMS-Audit)** | ACAMS | 2023
- **Certified Fraud Examiner (CFE) | ACFE | 2018**
- **Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA)** | ISACA | 2015
- **Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)** | (ISC)² | 2021
- **Certified Cryptocurrency Auditor –** BlockChain Council |2025

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

CBUAE Regulations • UAE Federal Laws • FATF Recommendations • Wolfsberg Principles • Transaction Monitoring • Sanctions Screening • Customer Due Diligence (CDD/EDD) • PEP & Adverse Media Screening • STR/SAR Decisioning • Regulatory Reporting • FIU Engagement • Enterprise Risk Assessment • Customer Risk Rating • Risk-Based Approach • Regulatory Examinations • Internal/External Audit Support • Control Testing

Leadership & Governance

MLRO / Deputy MLRO Responsibilities • Compliance Committee Reporting • Board-Level Management Information • Policy Development • SOP Design • Control Framework Implementation • Team Leadership • Training & Development • Change Management • Stakeholder Management

Technology & Data Analytics

AML Systems: goAML (implementation & reporting), Kiya.ai (transaction monitoring & alert review) • Data & Analytics: Power BI (dashboards & MI), SQL (data analysis & alert trending), Python (data analytics, basic ML), Excel & Power Query (modeling & QA scoring) • Compliance Technology: Scenario governance, false positive optimization, model validation concepts • Cybersecurity: ISO 27001 controls, VAPT concepts, information security governance

LANGUAGES

English: Fluent | **Hindi:** Fluent | **Nepali:** Native